

1823



The Alaungpaya dynasty's invasion of northern India led to Britain declaring war and eventually capturing the coastal city of Rangoon, pictured.

IN HIS ANNUAL MESSAGE TO THE US Congress on December 2, President James Monroe (see panel, below) outlined a new diplomatic policy: the **Monroe Doctrine**. Concerned about the possibility of European incursion into the new republics of Latin America, Monroe attempted to **set boundaries** between Europe and the Americas. The doctrine stated that the US would not interfere in the internal affairs or wars of European powers, nor in any colonies in the Americas, but likewise declared the western hemisphere now closed to any further European attempts at **colonization**. Interference with territories in the Americas would now be viewed as hostile acts against the US.

Earlier in the year, another republic had joined the Americas: the **United Provinces of Central**

America, which was composed of Guatemala, El Salvador, Nicaragua, Honduras, and Costa Rica. They had achieved independence from Spain in 1821, but were joined to the empire of Mexico. The local leaders decided to break away and establish a federal republic, with the capital in **Guatemala City**.

The **Alaungpaya Dynasty** of Burma (present-day Myanmar, see 1752), had been making incursions into the northern Indian state of **Assam**, bringing them into contact with the British, who were occupying the region. In an effort to protect their interests in India, Britain launched the **First Anglo-Burmese War** the following year (1824–26). This resulted in the British capture of much of the territory of Burma, including **Rangoon**, which was taken in 1825.

US ISOLATIONISM

James Monroe (1758–1831, see right) was the fifth president of the United States, serving from 1817–25. His time in office was a period during which the US began to emerge as a serious global power. This period was known as the “era of good feelings,” and was marked by significant economic growth and general public optimism. With its aversion to interference in other nations’ affairs set out in the Monroe Doctrine, the US began to pursue a policy of isolationism.



1824



This print depicts the Ottoman siege of Missolonghi, where the Greeks had established a provisional government during their war for independence.



Lord Byron

The Romantic poet Lord Byron was inspired by the Greek struggle for independence from the Ottoman Empire, and went to Greece to fight.

AS THE FIGHT FOR GREEK INDEPENDENCE INTENSIFIED,

it attracted the public’s attention across Europe, especially among writers and artists. One such person was the English **Romantic poet Lord Byron** (1788–1824), famed for his poem *Don Juan*. Byron had arrived in Greece the previous year to help fight in the struggle. However, while he was abroad, he contracted a serious illness and died on April 19 in **Missolonghi**.

In Peru, a decisive victory at the **Battle of Ayacucho**, December 9, meant the end of Spanish rule, though to the north, in the territory known as **Upper Peru**, loyalist forces were still holding out against rebel troops, in one of the last bastions of fighting.

1825



THE TERRITORY OF UPPER PERU

received a much-needed boost with the arrival of Simón Bolívar (see 1811) and **Antonio José de Sucre** (1785–1830), whose troops helped to defeat the Spanish. Bolívar wanted this territory to **unite** with the rest of Peru, but Sucre had already agreed with the rebel leaders that it would become a separate **republic**. In honor of Bolívar’s help, the rebels named the new nation **Bolivia**, and they invited Sucre to be its first president, which he accepted. With the creation of Bolivia, all the former Spanish colonies—with the exception of Cuba, Puerto Rico, and the Philippines—had become independent nations.

In England, there was great excitement over the opening, on September 27, of the **Stockton to Darlington** railroad line, in the industrial north of the country.

Technological innovations in the use of steam (see 1775 and 1786) to power engines had led to the development of railroad **locomotives**, such as the one designed by English inventor **John Blenkinsop** in 1812. **George Stephenson** (1781–1848), a colliery mechanic, improved on that design and caught the attention of a group of investors wishing to link the towns of Stockton and Darlington. Darlington was in the middle of a **coal mining** region and the Pennine mountains made transportation difficult. The 25-mile (40-km) line opened the way for further rail development.

Crowd puller

The opening of the Stockton to Darlington rail line marked the first time that a locomotive was used to pull a passenger train.



January 10 Edward Jenner, smallpox vaccine pioneer (b. 1749), dies

September 10 Simón Bolívar named president of Peru

April 19 Poet Lord Byron (b. 1788) dies in Missolonghi, Greece

Dutch cede Malacca to British

March 4 John Quincy Adams becomes sixth US president

June 20 Bourbon Charles X crowned King of France

September 27 Opening of the Stockton–Darlington Railway in Britain marks start of passenger rail travel using locomotives

United Provinces of Central America declare their independence (Guatemala, Honduras, Nicaragua, Costa Rica)

December 2 New diplomatic policy by US, the **Monroe doctrine**, posits noninterference by US and Europe in the Americas

First Anglo-Burmese War (to 1826) over Burma’s occupation of territory in northeast India

December 9 **Battle of Ayacucho** in Peru is a decisive victory over Spain

Javanese revolts against Dutch rule (to 1830)

August 6 Bolivia gains independence from Spain

October 26 Erie Canal opens in New York State, linking Lake Erie and the Hudson River